

What is new in ADULT PRIMARY CARE (APC) 2023.

APC 2023 aligns with the following National Department of Health policies and clinical protocols:

- Standard Treatment Guidelines and Essential Medicines List for South Africa. Primary Healthcare Level, 2020 Edition (v3).
- TB Screening and Testing Standard Operating Procedure, June 2022.
- National Guidelines on the Treatment of Latent TB Infection, February 2023.
- NDOH. National HIV Testing Services Policy, April 2023. *(Updated August 2023)*.
- NDOH: 2023 ART Clinical Guidelines for the Management of HIV in Adults, Pregnancy and Breastfeeding, Adolescents, Children, Infants and Neonates, June 2023.
- NDOH: Guideline for Vertical Transmission Prevention of Communicable Infections 2023, August 2023.
- National Clinical guidelines of Post-Exposure Prophylaxis in occupational and non-occupational exposures. NDOH. Approved 2019. Published 2020.
- 2021 Updated guidelines for the provision of Pre-Exposure Prophylaxis (PrEP) to persons at substantial risk of HIV infection. NDOH. October 2021.
- National guidelines for the management of Viral Hepatitis. NDOH. December 2019.
- Management of Rifampicin-Resistant Tuberculosis: A Clinical Reference Guide. November 2019
- Guidance document on the use of lateral flow lipoarabinomannan assay for the diagnosis of active tuberculosis in people living with HIV. NDOH. December 2020.
- Comprehensive STI Clinical Management Guidelines. NDOH. 2021-2025.
- Maternal, Perinatal, and Neonatal Health Policy. NDOH. 21 June 2021.
- National Contraception clinical guidelines. NDOH. 2019
- Clinical Guidelines for Breast Cancer Control and Management. NDOH. 2019.
- National User Guide on the Prevention and Treatment of Hypertension in Adults at PHC level. NDOH. 2021.
- National guidelines for the treatment of Malaria, South Africa, 2019
- COVID-19 Clinical Management Guidelines – version 5
- Guide to Antigen Testing for SARS-COV-2 in South Africa. NDOH. 2023.
- COVID-19 Disease: Infection Prevention and control Guidelines. Version 3. July 2021

What are the APC 2023 updates?

New pages and extensively revised sections include:

- The HIV section has been revised to include the transitioning of all patients to a dolutegravir-based ART regimen with updates to the clinic visit and blood test monitoring schedules. Pages that have been extensively revised include: Start or re-start ART, Switch ART, manage the unsuppressed VL pages.
 - The TB section has been updated to include a new page "Assess and manage TB infection" which provides guidance on managing TB exposures in TB contacts and treating latent TB infection. Updated recommendations regarding increased active TB screening and testing have also been included.
 - The contraception section has been revised to include a new pregnancy diagnosis page as well as recommendations around the newly available intrauterine device: LNG-IUD.
 - COVID-19 content has been integrated into existing pages and new pages have been added: Screen all patients for COVID-19, COVID-19 diagnosis, Acute COVID-19, Ongoing COVID symptoms, Long COVID: routine care
 - A new section has been added on preventing HIV with pre-exposure prophylaxis (PrEP).
 - Other new pages in this update include: Chronic pain, Skin ulcer or non-healing wound: routine care, Support the patient taking chronic medication, Observation post vaccination.
- For more details, find a full '**Summary of Changes**' document on the Knowledge Hub.

Keep up to date with expected changes in clinical guidance

Clinical guidance and policies are continuously being updated as new evidence becomes available and clinicians are urged to be aware of expected changes in clinical practice.

Clinical guidance updates expected in 2023/2024 include:

- Clinical Management of RR-TB - 6-month BPaLL regimen
- Maternity Care Guidelines

Check regularly for new NDOH circulars, notices or memorandums indicating updates as per standard practice in government.

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APC is revised and improved based on feedback from end-users. Send your feedback to ktu@uct.ac.za